

Entertainment & Fun

Shanghai Expats Bars: Where Foreigners Actually Hang Out

(2026)

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Shanghai Expat Bars: Where Foreigners Actually Hang Out (2026)

Shanghai has the best nightlife in mainland China, and the expat bar scene is legendary.

Here are the actual bars where Shanghai's foreign community gathers -- with real addresses you can Didi or metro to.

Bund & Riverside Bars

* Bar Rouge

* Bund 18, 7F, 18 Zhongshan Dong Yi Road, Huangpu District (黄浦区中山东一路18号7楼)

18:00-04:00 | ¥80-120/cocktail, ¥200+ cover on weekends The most iconic rooftop bar in

Shanghai. Unobstructed views of Pudong skyline. Dress to impress. Gets packed after 11

PM. The terrace is magical at sunset. This is THE expat party spot.

* Website

* The Nest

* Bund 18, 6F, 18 Zhongshan Dong Yi Road, Huangpu District (黄浦区中山东一路18号6楼)

18:00-02:00 | ¥90-130/cocktail More upscale than Bar Rouge, same building.

Nordic-inspired cocktails and food. The crowd is older, more sophisticated. Great for business entertaining. Reservations essential on weekends.

* Website

* Hakkasan

* Bund 18, 5F, 18 Zhongshan Dong Yi Road, Huangpu District (黄浦区中山东一路18号5楼)

18:00-01:00 | ¥100-150/cocktail World-renowned Cantonese restaurant with an incredible bar. The cocktails are Asian-fusion masterpieces. Expensive but worth it for special occasions. Dress smart.

* Website

Former French Concession (法租界)



* The Public

* 101 Maoming Nan Road, Jing'an District (静安区茂名南路101号) 18:00-02:00 |

¥60-90/cocktail Legendary expat cocktail bar that's been around forever. The bartenders know everyone's name. Classic cocktails done right -- the Martini is perfect. Feels like a neighborhood living room. The crowd is 80% foreign.

* SmartShanghai

* Senator Saloon

* 98 Jianguo West Road, Xuhui District (徐汇区建国西路98号) 17:00-02:00 | ¥60-90/cocktail

American whiskey bar with the best bourbon selection in Shanghai. Dark wood, leather booths, and country music. The Old Fashioned is legendary. Always packed with Americans and Brits. No reservations -- first come, first served.

* SmartShanghai

* Flask

* 458 Shaanxi South Road, Xuhui District (徐汇区陕西南路458号) 19:00-02:00 |



¥70-100/cocktail Hidden speakeasy behind a Coca-Cola vending machine door. The cocktails are experimental and Instagram-worthy. Intimate space, max 30 people. Go early or wait in line. The "Tiki Flask" is their signature.

* SmartShanghai

* Epic Cocktail Bar

* Found 158, 158 Julu Road, Jing'an District (静安区巨鹿路158号Found 158) 19:00-02:00 |

¥65-90/cocktail Located in the Found 158 complex (a former underground bomb shelter turned bar street). Creative cocktails with Chinese ingredients. The bartenders are award-winning. Try the "Sichuan Negroni."

* SmartShanghai

* Sasha's

* 11 Hengshan Road, Xuhui District (徐汇区衡山路11号) 11:00-02:00 | ¥50-70/beer,

¥70-90/cocktail Set in a gorgeous 1920s heritage villa. The garden terrace is perfect for Sunday brunch. Western food is solid. The crowd is a mix of expats and Chinese yuppies.



Live music on weekends.

* Website

Craft Beer & Brewpubs

* Daga Brewpub

* 57 Yuyuan Road, Jing'an District (静安区愚园路57号) 11:00-00:00 | ¥40-60/pint 30+ craft

beers on tap, mostly Chinese craft breweries. The outdoor seating on Yuyuan Road is great for people-watching. The IPA flight (4 x 150ml for ¥80) is the best way to explore.

Food is solid pub grub.

* Amap

* Boxing Cat Brewery (拳击猫)

* 519 Fuxing Middle Road, Xuhui District (徐汇区复兴中路519号) 11:00-00:00 | ¥45-65/pint

Shanghai's OG craft brewery. The TKO IPA and Sucker Punch Pale Ale are classics. Great American-style food. Multiple locations but this one has the best atmosphere.



* Website

* Tap House

* 398 Jiangsu Road, Changning District (长宁区江苏路398号) 16:00-00:00 | ¥40-55/pint

Neighborhood craft beer bar with a rotating tap list. The owner is a beer nerd who sources unique brews. Chill vibe, good music, and a friendly crowd. Perfect for a weeknight drink.

* SmartShanghai

Live Music & Late Night

* JZ Club

* 46 Fuxing West Road, Xuhui District (徐汇区复兴西路46号) 20:00-02:00 | ¥50-100 (cover varies) Shanghai's premier jazz club since 2004. World-class musicians play nightly. The basement venue has incredible acoustics. Reservations recommended for weekends.

* Website



* Heyday Jazz Bar

* Ferguson Lane, 376 Wukang Road, Xuhui District (徐汇区武康路376号武康亭)

19:00-01:00 | ¥60-80/cocktail Intimate jazz bar in the beautiful Ferguson Lane complex.

More upscale than JZ Club. Great cocktails and a sophisticated crowd. Perfect for a date night.

* SmartShanghai

* Revolucion Cocktail

* 101 Maoming Nan Road, Jing'an District (静安区茂名南路101号) 20:00-04:00 |

¥60-90/cocktail Cuban-themed cocktail bar with live salsa music. The mojitos are legit.

Gets wild after midnight -- dancing on tables is not uncommon. Multiple locations but

Maoming Road is the original.

* Website

* Windows Garage

* 101 Maoming Nan Road, Jing'an District (静安区茂名南路101号) 20:00-02:00 |



¥40-60/beer Dive bar with live rock and indie bands. Sticky floors, cheap beer, and loud music -- exactly what you want at 1 AM. The crowd is a mix of expats, musicians, and night owls.

* SmartShanghai

Insider Tips:

* Former French Concession (Xuhui/Jing'an) has the highest density of expat bars -- walk between them

* Found 158 (巨鹿路158号) is a bar complex in a former bomb shelter -- multiple bars in one underground space

* Bund bars are expensive but worth it for the view -- go at sunset, leave before the cover charge kicks in

* Use

* SmartShanghai

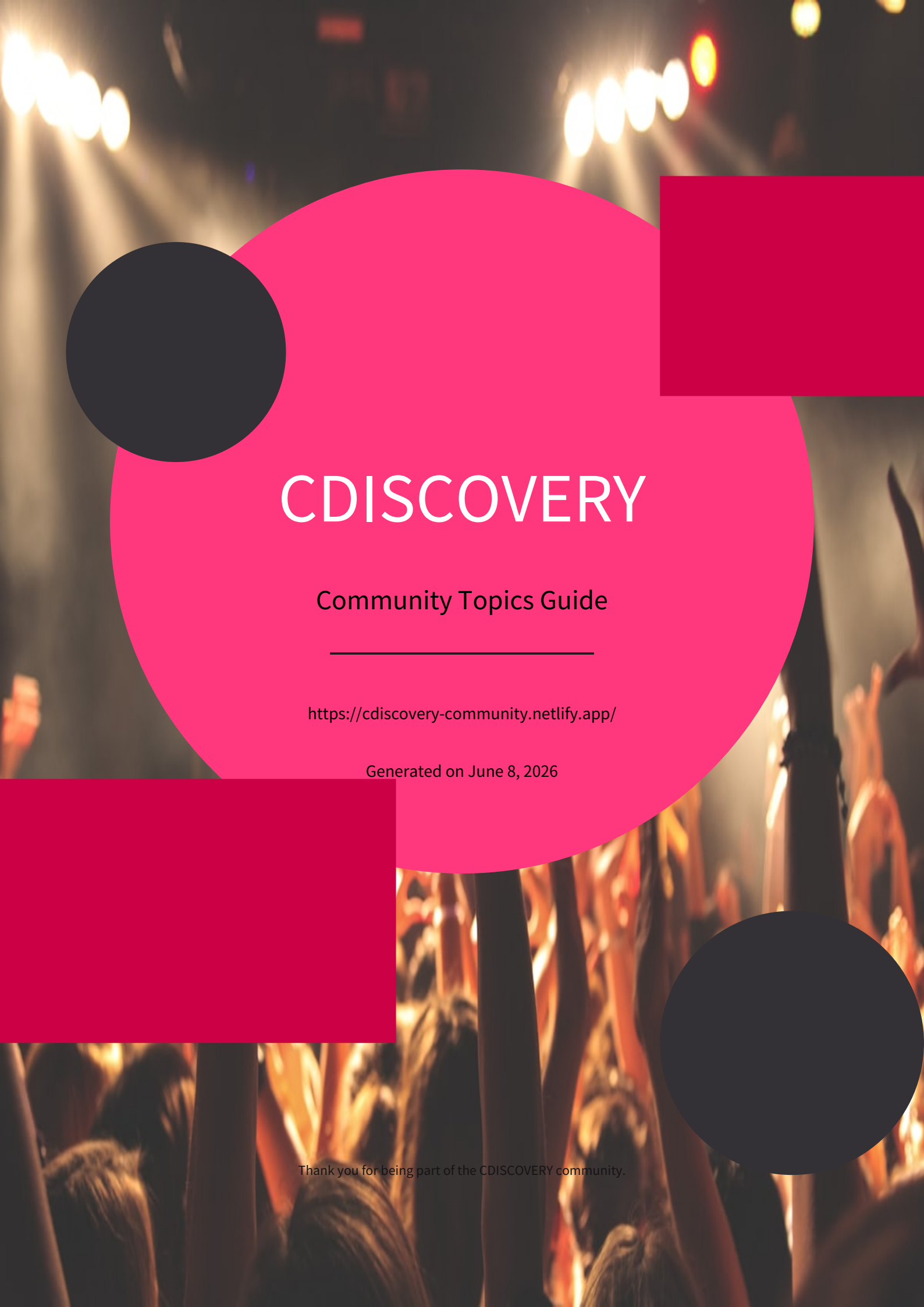


* for weekly bar events and specials

* Didi is your friend after midnight -- metro closes at 11 PM

* WeChat: search "Shanghai expats" or "上海外国人" for party invites and event listings

Sources: Sources: [SmartShanghai](https://www.smartshanghai.com/venue/bars) • [Bar Rouge](https://www.barrouge-shanghai.com) • [Boxing Cat](https://www.boxingcatbrewery.com) • [JZ Club](https://www.jzclub.cn)

The background of the entire page is a photograph of a concert crowd with their hands raised in the air, illuminated by bright stage lights. Overlaid on this background are several geometric shapes: a large pink circle in the center, a smaller dark grey circle in the top left, a pink rectangle in the top right, a pink rectangle in the bottom left, and a dark grey circle in the bottom right.

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